Indian Knowledge System (IKS)

5-Mark Questions & Answers

Simple Language — Easy to Understand & Remember

UNIT 1 — Introduction to Indian Knowledge System

Q1. What is Indian Knowledge System (IKS)? Explain its three parts.

Answer: IKS means the knowledge that was created by the people of India over thousands of years. This knowledge covers everything — from science and maths to art, medicine, and spiritual life. It has 3 main parts:

- **1. Indian:** This does not just mean today's India. It means the whole Indian subcontinent — from Burma (east) to Afghanistan (west), and from the Himalayas (north) to the Indian Ocean (south). All these areas shared the same culture and ideas. For example, Chanakya studied in Taxila (now Pakistan) and helped build the Mauryan Empire in eastern India. This shows how connected the region was.
- **2. Knowledge:** This means wisdom gained through experience, observation, and practice. It can be oral (spoken and passed on through stories, songs, and traditions) or written (books, scriptures). Knowledge is not just facts — it comes from deep thinking, living, and experimenting.
- **3. System:** India has a huge amount of knowledge. Without a system, it would be very confusing. So the 'System' means organizing all this knowledge into clear groups and showing how different parts connect with each other. This makes it easy to learn and use.

Q2. Why is it important to study IKS? Give 5 reasons.

Answer: Here are 5 simple reasons why we should study IKS:

- **1. Rich Heritage:** India has thousands of years of wisdom. Studying IKS helps us understand our cultural roots and the knowledge passed down by our ancestors.
- **2. Holistic Learning:** IKS does not separate subjects. It combines science, philosophy, arts, and spirituality together. This gives us a complete picture of life.
- **3. Great Inventions:** India gave the world Zero, the Decimal System, Algebra, and Ayurveda. These are still used every day across the globe.
- **4. Useful in Daily Life:** Ancient wisdom from Ayurveda (natural medicine), Yoga (fitness & mental peace), and Vedic Maths is still practically useful today.
- **5. Helps the Environment:** Ancient Indians knew how to live in harmony with nature. Their farming and conservation methods are very helpful now because of climate change.

Q3. What is 'Knowledge' in IKS? Explain Tacit and Explicit Knowledge.

Answer: In IKS, knowledge is not just reading from books. It is wisdom gained by living, thinking deeply, and experimenting. There are two types:

- **1. Tacit Knowledge (Unwritten):** This is knowledge in people's heads and hands. It is passed from person to person through talking, showing, and doing — not through books. Examples: folk medicines, farming tricks, traditional dances, oral stories. India has very rich oral traditions. Tacit knowledge can survive for thousands of years without being written.
- **2. Explicit Knowledge (Written):** When a wise person writes down what they have learned, it becomes explicit knowledge. This is stored in books, texts, and manuscripts. Examples: the Vedas, Upanishads, Arthashastra. These can be formally studied and shared with everyone.

Both types are equally important. IKS says knowledge comes from experience, observation, and analysis — not just memorizing facts.

Q4. Why is a 'System' needed in IKS? What does it do?

Answer: India has a huge ocean of knowledge — covering thousands of years and dozens of subjects. Without a system, a student would not know where to start. Here is what the System does:

- **Organizes Knowledge:** It groups and arranges all knowledge into clear categories so it is easy to find and study.
- **Makes Learning Easy:** A beginner can follow the system step by step without getting confused or lost.
- **Shows Connections:** The system shows how different areas of knowledge are linked. For example, Ayurveda (medicine) is connected to philosophy and biology. Understanding connections makes learning deeper.
- **Preserves Knowledge:** By codifying (writing down and classifying) knowledge, the system makes sure it is not lost over time.

In short, the System turns a massive, confusing collection of wisdom into something organized, easy to access, and meaningful.

Q5. What is the IKS Cell under the Ministry of Education? What are its goals?

Answer: IKS stands for Indian Knowledge System. The Government of India has set up an IKS Cell at AICTE (All India Council for Technical Education), New Delhi, under the Ministry of Education (MoE).

Its main goals are:

- To encourage research on all parts of Indian Knowledge System.
- To save and share IKS knowledge for further study and use in society.
- To spread awareness about India's rich traditional knowledge.
- To cover fields like Arts, Science, Engineering, Architecture, Medicine, Management, Agriculture, and Economics.

IKS is described as Jnan (Knowledge) + Vigyan (Science) + Jeevan Darshan (Philosophy of Life) — all coming from experience, observation, and deep thinking. It is a government effort to bring ancient Indian wisdom into modern education.

UNIT 2 — Vedic Corpus, Ancient Knowledge & IKS Classification

Q6. What is IKS Corpus? Explain its Literary and Non-Literary sources.

Answer: IKS Corpus means the entire collection of Indian knowledge — all texts, manuscripts, books, and oral traditions together. It covers subjects like philosophy, science, maths, medicine, art, and spirituality.

It is divided into two types:

- **A. Literary Sources (Written):** These are written texts in three groups:
- Vedic Literature — The four Vedas, Upanishads, Puranas, etc. Written mainly in Sanskrit. This is the biggest part.
- Other Dharmik Traditions — Texts from Buddhism, Jainism, and other Indian spiritual traditions.
- Regional Languages — A huge collection of knowledge written in Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Bengali, and other Indian languages.
- **B. Non-Literary Sources (Oral):** These are oral traditions — knowledge passed through speaking, not writing. Examples: folk songs, stories, rituals, dance, community practices. India has very rich oral traditions that carry ancient wisdom about life, nature, and medicine.

Together, written and oral sources form the complete knowledge heritage of India.

Q7. Why is studying ancient knowledge important? Give 4 points.

Answer:

- **1. Understand History:** Ancient knowledge shows us how human civilization grew and developed. It tells us where today's science, maths, and medicine came from. For example, ancient Indian maths gave us algebra and trigonometry.
- **2. Learn Different Cultures:** Studying ancient knowledge helps us understand different ways of thinking, living, and believing. It teaches us to respect other traditions and cultures.
- **3. See How Ideas Changed:** We can see which ancient ideas are still used today (like Yoga and Ayurveda) and which ones changed over time. This helps us understand progress and continuity.
- **4. Root of Modern Technology:** Many modern technologies came from ancient discoveries. For example, ancient Indian astronomy helped develop modern space science. Ancient medicine inspired modern pharmaceuticals.

In simple words — ancient knowledge is the foundation on which our modern world is built.

Q8. Write the history of IKS from ancient times to today.

Answer: IKS has a very long history. Here is a simple timeline:

- **1. Vedic Period (around 1500 BCE):** The Vedas were written. Scholars made big discoveries in maths (zero, decimal system), astronomy, and medicine.
- **2. Philosophical Period:** The Upanishads were written, exploring deep questions about the soul, God, and the meaning of life.
- **3. Great Empires (Maurya & Gupta):** Knowledge grew a lot during these empires. Great scholars like Aryabhata (astronomy) and Chanakya (politics) lived in this period.
- **4. Silk Road Era:** Indian knowledge traveled to other countries through trade routes. Ideas were exchanged with Chinese, Greek, and Arab scholars.

- **5. Islamic/Persian Period:** There was an exchange of knowledge in architecture, astronomy, and maths between Indian and Islamic cultures.
- **6. British Colonial Period:** British rule damaged traditional knowledge. Western education was pushed, and Indian knowledge was ignored or looked down upon.
- **7. After Independence (1947):** India started reviving its traditional knowledge. New research institutes were set up and education reforms were made.
- **8. Today:** Yoga, Ayurveda, and Indian philosophy are now famous and respected worldwide. The IKS Cell was established to formally bring this knowledge back into education.

Q9. What are the unique features of IKS? Explain any 5.

Answer: IKS has many special features that make it different from other knowledge systems:

- **1. Ancient Texts:** IKS has thousands of ancient books — the Vedas, Upanishads, Arthashastra, etc. These cover topics from science and maths to medicine and spirituality. They are thousands of years old but still valuable.
- **2. Yoga and Ayurveda:** Yoga helps keep the body fit and the mind calm. Ayurveda is a natural system of medicine using herbs and lifestyle practices. Both are now popular all over the world.
- **3. Zero and Decimal System:** India invented Zero and the Decimal Number System. Without zero, modern computers, banking, and science would not work. This is India's greatest gift to the world.
- **4. Gurukul System:** In ancient India, students lived with their teacher (Guru) and learned everything — from books to values to life skills. This gave a complete education, not just academic knowledge.
- **5. Non-Violence (Ahimsa):** Indian wisdom teaches Ahimsa — not hurting any living being. This principle, followed by Mahatma Gandhi, changed the world and inspired peace movements globally.

Q10. What is Sanatan Dharma? Explain its main values.

Answer: Sanatan Dharma is one of the oldest ways of life in India. 'Sanatan' means eternal (forever) and 'Dharma' means righteous way of living. It teaches people how to live a good, honest, and meaningful life. Its main values are:

- **Ahimsa (Non-Violence):** Do not hurt any living being — not in actions, not in words, not even in thoughts. Be kind to everyone.
- **Satya (Truth):** Always speak the truth and be honest in everything you do.
- **Dharma (Duty):** Do your duties honestly — as a student, child, parent, or citizen. Do what is right.
- **Sanyam (Self-Control):** Control your anger, greed, and desires. Do not go to extremes.
- **Seva (Service):** Help others without expecting anything in return. Serving people is like serving God.
- **Respect for Elders:** Always respect your parents, teachers, and elders. Their experience and guidance are valuable.
- **Cleanliness:** Keep yourself, your home, and the environment clean — in body and in mind.

In short, Sanatan Dharma is not just a religion — it is a complete and timeless guide to living a good life.

Q11. What is Dharmik Tradition? Explain its main practices.

Answer: Dharmik tradition means the religious and spiritual practices in Indian culture that are based on Dharma (living righteously). Here are its main practices:

- **Duty:** Every person must do their job or responsibility well — at home, at work, and in society.
- **Respect for Elders:** Always be polite and respectful to parents, grandparents, and teachers. Take their blessings and advice.
- **Daily Prayers and Rituals:** Doing puja (worship), chanting, and meditation every day to connect with God and keep the mind peaceful.
- **Festivals:** Celebrating festivals like Diwali, Holi, and Navratri with joy. This brings families and communities together.
- **Pilgrimage:** Visiting holy places like Varanasi, Tirupati, or Kedarnath to grow spiritually.
- **Respect for Nature:** Treating nature as sacred. Many rituals honor rivers, trees, and animals — showing that all life is important.
- **Karma:** Believing that good actions bring good results, and bad actions bring bad results. So always do good.
- **Charity and Service:** Giving to the poor and helping others is an important religious duty.

Dharmik tradition is a complete way of life that combines spiritual practice with moral values and social responsibility.

Q12. Write a short note on the Gurukul System of Education.

Answer: The Gurukul system was India's ancient education system. It is one of the best and most unique education systems in the world.

How it worked:

- Students (called Shishyas) left their homes and went to live with their teacher (Guru).
- They stayed there for many years — sometimes 10 to 15 years.
- Education was completely free. At the end, students gave Guru Dakshina — a gift or service as a thank-you.
- Learning was not only from books. Students learned by watching, doing, and living alongside their Guru.
- Subjects included Vedas, maths, astronomy, medicine, music, dance, archery, philosophy, and governance.
- Students also learned values like honesty, discipline, kindness, and hard work.

Why it was special:

- The Guru knew every student personally and taught according to each one's strengths and interests.
- It produced well-rounded, wise, and disciplined people — not just bookish scholars.
- Character building was as important as academic learning.

Importance Today: Many modern schools and educators are trying to bring back the personal teacher-student bond that the Gurukul system had. It was truly ahead of its time.

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